

JOURNAL OF EDUCATIONAL MANAGEMENT AND SUPERVISION (JEMAS)



Published in the Department of Educational Administration and Planning,
Joseph Sarwuan Tarka University, Makurdi

Influence of Classroom and Play Facilities Provisions on Pupils' Academic Performance in Primary Schools in Makurdi Metropolis in Benue State, Nigeria

Dr. Christiana Amichi Agbulu
Department of Educational Administration and Planning,
Joseph Sarwuan Tarka University Makurdi

And

Amina Muhammed
Department of Educational Administration and Planning,
Joseph Sarwuan Tarka University Makurdi

Abstract

This study examined the influence of classroom and play facilities provision on pupils' academic performance in primary schools in Makurdi metropolis in Benue State Nigeria. Two research objectives with two corresponding research questions and hypotheses were raised and formulated. The study adopted descriptive survey design. The population of the study was 1,593 which comprised of Head teachers and teachers from the five primary schools selected in Makurdi metropolis. The sample size was 165. Simple random sampling technique was used for the study. Self-structured questionnaire titled influence of school facilities provision on pupils' academic performance questionnaire was used as instrument for data collection. The reliability of the instrument was established using Cronbach Alpha coefficient and a reliability coefficient of 0.88 was obtained. Data collected were analyzed using descriptive statistics of mean and standard deviation to answer the research questions while t-test was used to test the null hypotheses at 0.05 level of significance. The findings of the study revealed that classroom and play facilities provisions have significant influence on pupils' academic performance as perceived by primary school teachers in Makurdi metropolis. Based on the findings, it was recommended amongst others that policy makers and education stakeholders should work towards improving the availability and

quality of adequate classroom and play facilities provisions in primary schools to enhance effective learning towards better academic performance among pupils.

Keywords: Primary School, Teacher, Classroom Facility, Play Facility, Pupils Academic performance

Introduction

Education is an enterprise in which both government, private individuals, invest their resources. Education is a continuous process which the society establishes to assist its members to understand the heritage of the past and participate productively in the future which usually has its foundation from primary school. Primary school is a starting point for a child's development and the key foundation of the Nigerian educational system. Primary schools in Nigeria refer to the education provided to children at elementary level typically from ages 6 to 11.

In the primary school, formal organization where pupils are fostered with desirable and relevant changes in behavior and attitude so as to become useful and functional in the society. It is an educational institution designed to provide learning spaces and learning environments for the teaching of pupils under the direction of teachers (Asiyai, 2010). It is also important that the teachers and pupils are properly accommodated to facilitate the teaching and learning that goes on in the primary schools (Bardi & Juhuardi, 2017). Facilities in primary school can be defined as the entire school plant which school administrators, teachers and pupils' harness, allocate and utilize for the smooth and effective teaching and learning experiences (Asiyai 2012). According to (Maingi, et al, 2017) facilities in primary schools are the physical spatial enablers of teaching and learning which will increase the production of results. School facilities serve as pillars of support for effective teaching and learning. These facilities include all of the infrastructure and material resources. Within the context of this study and primary school, one refers to classroom and play facilities for the primary school pupils.

In Nigeria, primary school pupils' enrolment has continued to increase without a corresponding check on the increase in classroom and play facilities for effective teaching and learning. Oyedele in Durosaro and Ogunsaju (2002) defines classroom and play facilities to include the site, the building and other infrastructures. They went further to say that these facilities embrace permanent and semi-permanent structures which includes items such as machines, toy store, the chalk board and office assistance tools such as brooms and cleaning materials. According to Abraham (2003) classroom and play facilities mean all physical faculties and equipment within the school which are used by the teachers and pupils of the school community. Classroom and play facilities are educational equipment that includes machine, audiovisual materials, chalkboards, cleaner's tools and workshop equipment (Alessandroni, 2023). The issue of classroom and play facilities provision in primary schools in Nigeria seemed to be a problem as one has not practically ascertained the availability state. Classroom and play facilities enable the pupils to develop problem solving skills and positive scientific attitudes (Ajayi & Ogunyemi, 2020). The authors reiterated that when these facilities are provided to meet relative needs of primary school system,

pupils will not only have access to the reference materials mentioned by teacher, but individual pupils will also learn at their own pace. Classroom and play facilities in primary schools are supposed to be encouraging. All primary schools are supposed to have chalk board, ceiling/fans, roofs, windows and doors in the classroom (Farombi, 2022). This means that adequate and quality of classroom and play facilities in primary schools affect academic performance of pupils' (Ugwulashi, 2017). However, one cannot say whether or not these facilities are provided. Hence, the study: Influence of Classroom and Play Facilities Provisions on Pupils' Academic Performance as perceived by the teachers in Primary Schools in Makurdi Metropolis in Benue State, Nigeria. The provision of these facilities perhaps varies according to the school location.

School location refers to where a given school is situated. It could be in an urban or rural area, a lot of researches had been carried out in respect to school locations and some hold the view that location influences the academic performance of students based on facilities available. A stimulating school location arouses the pupils to learn. Buder (2020) observed that conducive school for learning includes: Physical location of the school, the physical setting of the classrooms, teaching aids/materials and the quality of the teachers. Hence, gender was a variable in this study.

Objectives of the Study

The study examined the influence of classroom and play facilities provision on pupils' academic performance in primary schools in Makurdi Metropolis in Benue State Nigeria. Specifically, the study determined:

1. the influence of classroom facilities provisions on pupils' academic performance in primary schools in Makurdi Metropolis in Benue State Nigeria.
2. the influence of play facilities provisions on pupils' academic performance in primary schools in Makurdi Metropolis in Benue State Nigeria.

Research Questions

The following research questions were raised to guide the study.

1. What is the influence of classroom facilities provisions on pupils' academic performance in primary schools in Makurdi Metropolis in Benue State Nigeria?
2. What is the influence of play facilities provisions on pupils' academic performance in primary schools in Makurdi Metropolis in Benue State Nigeria?

1.5 Hypotheses

1. There is no significant difference in the mean responses of teachers of urban and rural primary schools on the influence of classroom facilities provision on students' academic performance in Makurdi Metropolis Benue State Nigeria.
2. There is no significant difference in the mean responses of teachers of urban and rural primary school on the influence of play facilities provision on pupils' academic performance in primary schools in Makurdi Metropolis in Benue State Nigeria.

Methodology

The area of the study was Makurdi Metropolis Benue State Nigeria. The study adopted descriptive survey research design. The population of the study was made up of 1593 head teachers and teachers in primary schools. The sample for the study consists 65 head teachers and teachers drawn using simple random sampling techniques. The instrument was a questionnaire developed by the researcher. The items are structured on a four-point rating scale of SA= Strongly Agree (4), A=Agree (3), D=Disagree (2), and SD=Strongly Disagree (1). The questionnaire was subjected to face validation by experts. The reliability of the instrument was computed using Cronbach's Alpha and the grand reliability obtained was 0.88. Data collected were analyzed with descriptive statistics of mean and standard deviation to answer the research questions while t-test was used to test the null hypotheses at 0.05 level of significance. A criterion mean of 2.50 was established such that a mean score of 2.50 and above was agreed as having a significant influence and any mean rating from 2.49 below was disagreed as not having a significant influence. The decision criterion for the null hypotheses was that a P-value less than alpha value of 0.05 was statistically significant; a P-value equal to or greater than the alpha value of 0.05 was not statistically significant.

Results

The results of the study according to research questions and hypotheses are:

Research Question 1: What is the influence of classroom facilities provisions on pupils' academic performance in primary schools in Makurdi Metropolis in Benue State Nigeria?

Table 1: Mean and Standard Deviation of Teachers on the Influence of Classroom Facilities Provision on Pupils' Academic Performance

s/no	Item Description	Mean	S.D	Decision
1	Adequate furniture (chairs, desks, boards) in classrooms makes the students feel comfortable for learning thus enhance academic performance.	2.67	1.14	Accepted
2	Observing considerable class size ratio reduces classroom management problems for teachers which lead to effective teaching towards enhancing students' performance.	2.56	1.19	Accepted
3	Availability of classroom instructional materials facilitates students' learning ability.	2.55	1.12	Accepted
4	Provision of classroom book-shelves helps students in proper storage of textbooks for easy access towards reading for improvement in learning outcome.	2.52	1.03	Accepted
5	Availability of clean blackboards or whiteboards aids students note taking and memorization for better academic performance.	2.50	1.02	Accepted

Clusters	2.56	1.10	Accepted
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The results Table 1 indicates that teachers perceive the provision of classroom facilities such as adequate furniture, appropriate class sizes, instructional materials, bookshelves, and clean boards as positively influencing pupils' academic performance. All items received mean scores around 2.50 to 2.67 with standard deviations approximately 1.02 to 1.19, and the overall cluster mean of 2.56 suggests a general agreement on this influence. Since all items are marked as "Accepted," it implies that teachers believe this classroom facilities significantly contribute to better learning outcomes in primary schools in Makurdi.

Research Question 2: What is the influence of play facilities provisions on pupils' academic performance in primary schools in Makurdi Metropolis in Benue State Nigeria?

Table 2: Mean and Standard Deviation of Teachers on the Influence of Play Facilities Provision on Pupils' Academic Performance

S/No	Item Description	Mean	S.D	Decision
6	Adequate play facilities in school can has a significant positive influence on pupils' physical and social development.	2.88	1.06	Accepted
7	Play enhances students learning readiness and social skills.	3.03	1.06	Accepted
8	Playground allow children to practice collaborative skills.	2.79	1.04	Accepted
9	Playground allow students to practice problem solving and leadership.	2.90	.90	Accepted
10	Primary school playground can go a long way in influencing pupils' physical skills acquisition.	2.61	1.03	Accepted
Clusters		2.84	1.02	Accepted

Table 1 indicates that teachers strongly believe play facilities positively influence students' physical and social development, with mean scores notably high (around 2.88 to 3.03) and a cluster mean of 2.84. All items, including play's role in social skills, problem-solving, leadership, and

physical development, were accepted, indicating that play facilities are seen as vital for holistic development and enhancing learning readiness in primary schools.

Hypotheses

H0₁: There is no significant difference in the mean responses of teachers of urban and rural primary schools on the influence of classroom facilities provision on students' academic performance in Makurdi Metropolis Benue State Nigeria.

Table 3: Independent Sample t-test of Urban and Rural Teachers on the Influence of Classroom Facilities Provision on Pupils' Academic Performance

Variable	Group	Mean	Std.dev	t-value	p.value	Df	Remark
Classroom provision	Urban	8.28	1.57	-8.667	0.000	163	Sign.
	Rural	14.60	4.90				

The independent t-test in table 3 shows a significant difference between urban and rural teachers' responses regarding classroom facilities provisions, with urban school teachers reporting lower mean scores (8.28) compared to rural teachers (14.60). The t-value of -8.667 and p-value of 0.000 ($p < 0.05$) confirm a statistically significant difference.

H0₂: There is no significant difference in the mean responses of teachers of urban and rural primary school on the influence of play facilities provision on pupils' academic performance in primary schools in Makurdi Metropolis in Benue State Nigeria.

Table 4: Independent Sample t-test of Urban and Rural Teachers on the Influence of Play Facilities Provision on Pupils' Academic Performance

Variable	Group	Mean	Std.dev	t-value	p.value	Df	Remark
Play provision	Urban	13.34	4.40	-1.634	0.769	163	Sign.
	Rural	14.57	4.34				

Table 4 comparison for play facilities provisions shows no significant difference between urban (mean = 13.34) and rural (mean = 14.57) school teachers, as indicated by a t-value of -1.634 and a p-value of 0.769 (> 0.05). Both groups agree that play facilities positively influence student performance, and the similarity in responses suggests comparable perceptions of the importance and availability of play facilities across schools and location.

Discussion of Findings

There is a statistically significant difference between urban and rural primary school teachers' perceptions of classroom facilities provision on students' academic performance, with rural school teachers likely perceiving these facilities as more available or impactful ($t = -8.667$, $p = 0.000$). This finding agrees with Olumuyiwa & Arisekola (2023) who discovered that classroom was provided. There was significant different in the facilities provided in primary schools in the study area. In contrast, Osuji (2016) findings revealed that there is no significance difference in the

opinions of teachers and principals on the impact of teaching facilities on students' academic performance in public secondary schools in Giwa and Zaria Education Zones in Kaduna State. There is no significant difference in perceptions regarding play facilities provision between urban and rural primary school teachers, as evidenced by the high p-value ($p = 0.769$), suggesting both groups share similar views on the role of play facilities in pupils' performance. Jusue (2001) found that the physical condition of the school influenced students' academic performance. Dahar and Faize (2011) showed that school facilities are correlate of academic performance and therefore revealed that the attitude or interest of students is usually boosted positively towards learning.

Conclusion

The study reveals notable differences in the perceptions of urban and rural primary school teachers on classroom facilities provisions and on play facilities provisions, show no significant difference across the two groups, suggesting a shared view on their provisions of facilities. Overall, these findings highlight disparities in facilities provisions perceptions that could influence teaching and learning pupils' academic performance and outcomes.

Recommendations

The following recommendations were made based on the findings

1. Facilitate partnerships and facilities-sharing initiatives between urban and rural primary school teachers to bridge gaps in facility provision and foster best practices.
2. Policymakers and education stakeholders should work towards improving the availability and quality of classroom and play facilities provisions in urban and rural primary schools to match perceptions.

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